Yixin Zou

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Research Focus

My research sits at the intersection of human-computer interaction, computer security and privacy, and responsible artificial intelligence. I use computational and social science methods to (1) examine people's needs and experiences with digital technologies; (2) identify and measure the harms created and amplified by digital technologies; and (3) design and evaluate interventions that mitigate these harms and enhance people's online and offline experiences. My vision is to work toward a future in which digital technologies are safe and equitable for all, especially marginalized and underserved communities.

Education

2017–22 **Ph.D. in Information**, University of Michigan
Advisor: Florian Schaub

2015–17 **B.Sc. in Advertising**, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
Graduated with the highest honor (top 5% in the College of Media)

Appointments

2023– Tenure-Track Faculty (W2), Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy
2023– Principal Investigator, CASA Cluster of Excellence
2022 Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Michigan

Research Internships

2020 Meta, Privacy and Data Use
2019 NortonLifeLock Research Group
2019 Mozilla, Firefox Monitor

Selected Awards & Honors

2026 CNIL-EHESS Award [P7]
2026 Best Paper Award (top 1%), ACM CHI [P13]
2026 Best Paper Honorable Mention (top 5%), ACM CHI [P4]
2025 Diversity and Inclusion Recognition, ACM CSCW [P22]
2025 Runner up, CNIL-EHESS Award [P14]
2025 Best Paper Honorable Mention (top 5%), ACM CHI [P19]
2024 Google Academic Research Award

2024 ACM SIGCHI Outstanding Dissertation Award
2023 Meta Research Award
2022 John Karat Usable Privacy and Security Student Research Award
2021 Student Paper Honorable Mention, Future of Privacy Forum's Annual Privacy Papers for Policymakers Award [P36]
2020 Best Paper Honorable Mention (top 5%), ACM CHI [P38]
2019 Best Paper Honorable Mention (top 5%), ACM CHI [P41]
2019 NortonLifeLock Research Group Graduate Fellowship
2018 Distinguished Paper Award, SOUPS [P43]

Publications

See my Google Scholar profile for citation records.
In computer science and information science (CS/IS) research, top-tier conferences are highly selective venues for archival papers only, comparable to journals in other disciplines for their selectivity, visibility, and impact. One may refer to the CORE Rankings and the acceptance rate for a general idea of a conference's standing.
Authors are typically ordered such that leading students are listed from largest to smallest contribution from the left. Supervising faculty and postdocs are typically ordered from the right. The last author is the primary sponsor and supervisor.
* indicates equal contributions, usually for co-first or co-last authors.

Peer-Reviewed Conference and Journal Publications

[P1] Priyasha Chatterjee, Smirity Kaushik, Karola Marky, and **Yixin Zou**. "It Shouldn't Be This Difficult: Researcher Perspectives on Diversity and Inclusion in Usable Privacy and Security Research". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2026. [link].

[P2] Xiaowei Chen, Mindy Tran, Yue Deng, Bhupendra Acharya, and **Yixin Zou**. "From Harm to Healing: Understanding Individual Resilience after Cybercrimes". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2026. [link].

[P3] Ankolika De, Gabriel Lima, and **Yixin Zou**. "What is Safety? Corporate Discourse, Power, and the Politics of Generative AI Safety". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2026. [link].
Selected for presentation at the CNIL Privacy Day 2026.

[P4] Yue Deng, Xiaowei Chen, Junxiang Liao, Bo Li, and **Yixin Zou**. "Experiencer, Helper, or Observer: Online Fraud Intervention for Older Adults Through a Role-based Simulation Approach". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2026. [link].
Best Paper Honorable Mention.

[P5] Yue Deng, Changyang He, Bo Li, and **Yixin Zou**. ""What If My Face Gets Scanned Without Consent:" Understanding Older Adults' Experiences with Biometric Payment". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2026. [link].

[P6] Smirity Kaushik, Kyle Beadle, Gauri Nayak, Madelyn Rose Sanfilippo, Mainack Mondal, Yang Wang, Sai Teja Peddinti, Jingjie Li, and **Yixin Zou**. ""You Have Been Selected as the Winner": Characterizing User-Reported Scams on TikTok". *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)*. 2026. [link].

[P7] Gabriel Lima, Gustavo Gil Gasiola, Frederike Zufall, and **Yixin Zou**. "Do Citizens Agree with the EU AI Act? Public Perspectives on Risk and Regulation of AI Systems". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2026. [link].
Selected for presentation at the CNIL Privacy Day 2026
CNIL-EHESS Award (Best Contribution in Social Science on Privacy Protection).

[P8] Collins W. Munyendo, Veronica A. Rivera, Jackie Hu, Emmanuel Tweneboah, Amna Shahnawaz, Karen Sowon, Dilara Keküllüoğlu, Marcos Silva, Yue Deng, Mercy Omeiza, Gayatri Priyadarsini Kancherla, Maria Rosario Niniz Silva, Maryam Mustafa, Abhishek Bichhawat, Francisco Marmolejo-Cossio, Elissa Redmiles*, and **Yixin Zou***. ""I Wonder if These Warnings Are Accurate": Security and Privacy Advice in Nine Majority World Countries". *IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (Oakland)*. 2026. [link].

[P9] Agata Stanczyk, Mindy Tran, Tarini Saka, **Yixin Zou**, and Veelasha Moonsamy. "Revealed or Reinforced: How Assistive Technologies Shape the Experience with Dark Patterns for Blind and Low-Vision Users". *ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS)*. 2026. [link].

[P10] Mindy Tran, Xinru Tang, Adryana Hutchinson, Adam Aviv, and **Yixin Zou**. "Toward Inclusive Security and Privacy for Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing People: A Community-Based Interview Study". *IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (Oakland)*. 2026. [link].

[P11] Warda Usman, **Yixin Zou**, and Daniel Zappala. "Human-Centered Threat Modeling in Practice: Lessons, Challenges, and Paths Forward". *IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (Oakland)*. 2026. [link].

[P12] Yu Yamashita, Lin Kyi, Changyang He, Ankolika De, Maria Antoniak, **Yixin Zou**, and Asia Biega. "Defining the Problem, Setting the Standard? Platform Narratives and Interventions for Digital Well-Being". *ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT)*. 2026. [link].

[P13] Jiamin Zheng, Yue Deng, Jessica Chen, Shujun Li, **Yixin Zou**, and Jingjie Li. ""There is no way my own sister would scam me:" Understanding Narratives Around Scam-Driven Human Trafficking Across Chinese Borders on RedNote". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2026. [link].
Best Paper Award.

[P14] Kyle Beadle, Kieron Ivy Turk, Aliai Eusebi, Mindy Tran, Marilyne Ordekian, Enrico Mariconti, **Yixin Zou***, and Marie Vasek*. "SoK: A Privacy Framework for Security Research Using Social Media Data". *IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (Oakland)*. 2025. [link].
Selected for presentation at the CNIL Privacy Day 2025
Runner-up for CNIL-EHESS Award (Best Contribution in Social Science on Privacy Protection).

[P15] Annalina Buckmann, Jan Magnus Nold, Yasemin Acar, and **Yixin Zou**. "More than Usability: Differential Access to Digital Security and Privacy". *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)*. 2025. [link].

[P16] Yue Deng, Changyang He, **Yixin Zou**, and Bo Li. ""Auntie, Please Don't Fall for Those Smooth Talkers": How Chinese Younger Family Members Safeguard Seniors from Online Fraud". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2025. [link].
Selected for presentation at the CNIL Privacy Day 2026.

[P17] Franziska Herbert*, Collins W. Munyendo*, Jonas Hielscher, Steffen Becker, and **Yixin Zou**. "Digital Security Perceptions and Practices Around the World: A WEIRD versus Non-WEIRD Comparison". *USENIX Security Symposium*. 2025. [link].

[P18] Smirity Kaushik, Tanusree Sharma, Yaman Yu, Amna Ali, Bart Piet Knijnenburg, Yang Wang, and **Yixin Zou**. "Privacy Perceptions and Behaviors Towards Targeted Advertising on Social Media: A Cross-Country Study on the Effect of Culture and Religion". *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETs)*. 2025. [link].

[P19] Gabriel Lima, Nina Grgić-Hlača, Markus Langer, and **Yixin Zou**. "Lay Perceptions of Algorithmic Discrimination in the Context of Systemic Injustice". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2025. [link].
Best Paper Honorable Mention.

[P20] Byron Lowens, Sean Scarnecchia, Jane Im, Tanisha Afnan, Annie Chen, **Yixin Zou**, and Florian Schaub. "Misalignments and Demographic Differences in Expected and Actual Privacy Settings on Facebook". *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETs)*. 2025. [link].

[P21] Abhinaya SB, Abhishri Agrawal, Yaxing Yao, **Yixin Zou**, and Anupam Das. ""What are they gonna do with my data?": Privacy Expectations, Concerns, and Behaviors in Virtual Reality". *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETs)*. 2025. [link].

[P22] Xinru Tang, Gabriel Lima, Li Jiang, Lucy Simko, and **Yixin Zou**. "Beyond "Vulnerable Populations": A Unified Understanding of Vulnerability From A Socio-Ecological Perspective". *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW)*. 2025. [link].
Diversity and Inclusion Recognition.

[P23] Emmanuel Tweneboah, Collins W Munyendo, and **Yixin Zou**. ""No, I Can't Be a Security Personnel on Your Phone": Security and Privacy Threats From Sharing Infrastructure in Rural Ghana". *USENIX Security Symposium*. 2025. [link].

[P24] Franziska Herbert, Steffen Becker, Annalina Buckmann, Marvin Kowalewski, Jonas Hielscher, Yasemin Acar, Markus Dürmuth, **Yixin Zou**, and M Angela Sasse. "Digital Security–A Question of Perspective. A Large-Scale Telephone Survey with Four At-Risk User Groups". *IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (Oakland)*. 2024. [link].

[P25] Timo Speith, Julian Speith, Steffen Becker, **Yixin Zou**, Asia Biega, and Christof Paar. "Explainability as a Requirement for Hardware: Introducing Explainable Hardware (XHW)". *IEEE International Requirements Engineering Conference (RE)*. 2024. [link].

[P26] Kaiwen Sun, Jingjie Li, **Yixin Zou**, Jenny Radesky, Christopher Brooks, and Florian Schaub. "Unfulfilled Promises of Child Safety and Privacy: Portrayals and Use of Children in Smart Home Marketing". *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW)*. 2024. [link].
Selected for presentation at the CNIL Privacy Day 2024.

[P27] **Yixin Zou**, Khue Le, Peter Mayer, Alessandro Acquisti, Adam J Aviv, and Florian Schaub. "Encouraging Users to Change Breached Passwords Using the Protection Motivation Theory". *ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI)*. 2024. [link].
Selected for presentation at the CNIL Privacy Day 2024.

[P28] **Yixin Zou**, Kaiwen Sun, Tanisha Afnan, Ruba Abu-Salma, Robin Brewer, and Florian Schaub. "Cross-Contextual Examination of Older Adults' Privacy Concerns, Behaviors, and Vulnerabilities". *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETs)*. 2024. [link].

[P29] Peter Mayer, **Yixin Zou**, Byron M Lowens, Hunter A Dyer, Khue Le, Florian Schaub, and Adam J Aviv. "Awareness, Intention, (In)Action: Individuals' Reactions to Data Breaches". *ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI)*. 2023. [link].

[P30] Tanisha Afnan, **Yixin Zou**, Maryam Mustafa, Mustafa Naseem, and Florian Schaub. "Aunties, Strangers, and the FBI: Online Privacy Concerns and Experiences of Muslim-American Women". *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)*. 2022. [link].

[P31] Janet X Chen*, Allison McDonald*, **Yixin Zou***, Emily Tseng, Kevin A Roundy, Acar Tamersoy, Florian Schaub, Thomas Ristenpart, and Nicola Dell. "Trauma-Informed Computing: Towards Safer Technology Experiences for All". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2022. [link].

[P32] Hana Habib*, **Yixin Zou***, Yaxing Yao, Alessandro Acquisti, Lorrie Cranor, Joel Reidenberg, Norman Sadeh, and Florian Schaub. "Toggles, Dollar Signs, and Triangles: How to (In)Effectively Convey Privacy Choices with Icons and Link Texts". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2021. [link].
Icon recommendation adopted into the California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA) Regulations.

[P33] Peter Mayer*, **Yixin Zou***, Florian Schaub, and Adam J Aviv. ""Now I'm a bit angry:" Individuals' Awareness, Perception, and Responses to Data Breaches that Affected Them". *USENIX Security Symposium*. 2021. [link].
Selected for presentation at the FTC PrivacyCon 2021.

[P34] Kaiwen Sun, **Yixin Zou**, Jenny Radesky, Christopher Brooks, and Florian Schaub. "Child Safety in the Smart Home: Parents' Perceptions, Needs, and Mitigation Strategies". *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW)*. 2021. [link].
Selected for presentation at the FTC PrivacyCon 2022.

[P35] **Yixin Zou**, Allison McDonald, Julia Narakornpichit, Nicola Dell, Thomas Ristenpart, Kevin Roundy, Florian Schaub, and Acar Tamersoy. "The Role of Computer Security Customer Support in Helping Survivors of Intimate Partner Violence". *USENIX Security Symposium*. 2021. [link].

[P36] Hana Habib, Sarah Pearman, Jiamin Wang, **Yixin Zou**, Alessandro Acquisti, Lorrie Faith Cranor, Norman Sadeh, and Florian Schaub. ""It's a scavenger hunt": Usability of Websites' Opt-Out and Data Deletion Choices". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2020. [link].
Honorable Mention, FPF Privacy Papers for Policymakers.

[P37] Abraham Mhaidli, Manikandan Kandadai Venkatesh, **Yixin Zou**, and Florian Schaub. "Listen Only When Spoken To: Interpersonal Communication Cues as Smart Speaker Privacy Controls". *Proceedings on Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PoPETs)*. 2020. [link].

[P38] **Yixin Zou**, Kevin Roundy, Acar Tamersoy, Saurabh Shintre, Johann Roturier, and Florian Schaub. "Examining the Adoption and Abandonment of Security, Privacy, and Identity Theft Protection Practices". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2020. [link].
Best Paper Honorable Mention
Selected for presentation at the FTC PrivacyCon 2020.

[P39] Hana Habib, **Yixin Zou**, Aditi Jannu, Neha Sridhar, Chelse Swoopes, Alessandro Acquisti, Lorrie Faith Cranor, Norman Sadeh, and Florian Schaub. "An Empirical Analysis of Data Deletion and Opt-Out Choices on 150 Websites". *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)*. 2019. [link].
Selected for presentation at the FTC PrivacyCon 2020.

[P40] Abraham Mhaidli, **Yixin Zou**, and Florian Schaub. ""We Can't Live Without Them!" App Developers' Adoption of Ad Networks and Their Considerations of Consumer Risks". *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)*. 2019. [link].

[P41] Justin Petelka, **Yixin Zou**, and Florian Schaub. "Put Your Warning Where Your Link Is: Improving and Evaluating Email Phishing Warnings". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2019. [link].
Best Paper Honorable Mention.

[P42] **Yixin Zou**, Shawn Danino, Kaiwen Sun, and Florian Schaub. "You 'Might' Be Affected: An Empirical Analysis of Readability and Usability Issues in Data Breach Notifications". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*. 2019. [link].
Selected for presentation at the FTC PrivacyCon 2019.

[P43] **Yixin Zou**, Abraham H Mhaidli, Austin McCall, and Florian Schaub. ""I've Got Nothing to Lose": Consumers' Risk Perceptions and Protective Actions after the Equifax Data Breach". *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)*. 2018. [link].
Distinguished Paper Award.

Workshop Papers and Posters

[W1] Guanming Shi and **Yixin Zou**. "Position Paper: Explainable AI (XAI) in Financial Crimes Detection". *Workshop on Human-Centered Explainable AI (HCXAI) (co-located with ACM CHI 2026)*. 2026. [link].

[W2] Emmanuel Tweneboah, Collins W Munyendo, and **Yixin Zou**. ""No, I Can't Be a Security Personnel on Your Phone": Security and Privacy Threats From Sharing Infrastructure in Rural Ghana". *NYC Privacy Day*. 2025. [link].
Best Poster Award.

[W3] Smirity Kaushik, Tanusree Sharma, Yaman Yu, Amna F Ali, Yang Wang, and **Yixin Zou**. "Cross-Country Examination of People's Experience with Targeted Advertising on Social Media". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems Late-Breaking Work (CHI-LBW)*. 2024. [link].

[W4] Mindy Tran, Xinru Tang, Adryana Hutchinson, Adam J Aviv, and **Yixin Zou**. "Position Paper: Exploring Security and Privacy Needs of d/Deaf Individuals". *Workshop on Accessible Security and Privacy (co-located with IEEE Euro S&P 2024)*. 2024. [link].

[W5] Peter Mayer*, **Yixin Zou***, Florian Schaub, and Adam J Aviv. ""Now I'm a bit angry:" Individuals' Awareness, Perception, and Responses to Data Breaches that Affected Them". *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS) Poster Session*. 2022.

[W6] Kaiwen Sun, Jingjie Li, **Yixin Zou**, Florian Schaub, and Christopher Brooks. "The Portrayal of Children in Smart Home Marketing". *Workshop on Kids Online Privacy and Safety (co-located with SOUPS 2022)*. 2022.

[W7] Hana Habib, **Yixin Zou**, Chelse Swoopes, Aditi Jannu, Lorrie Faith Cranor, and Florian Schaub. "An Empirical Analysis of Online Consent and Opt-Out Experience". *Privacy Law Scholars Conference*. 2018.

[W8] **Yixin Zou** and Florian Schaub. "Concern But No Action: Consumers' Reactions to the Equifax Data Breach". *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems Late-Breaking Work (CHI-LBW)*. 2018. [link].

Invited Magazine Articles

[M1] **Yixin Zou** and Florian Schaub. "Beyond Mandatory: Making Data Breach Notifications Useful for Consumers". *IEEE Security & Privacy Magazine*. 2019. [link].

Technical Reports

[TR1] Cori Faklaris, **Yixin Zou**, Adam Jenkins, Anastasia Sergeeva, Apu Kapadia, Daricia Wilkinson, Sameer Patil, and Simran Munot. *Working Group Reports: Measurement, Methods, and Ethics*. Technical Report. Report from Dagstuhl Seminar 25261: Future of Human-Centered Privacy. 2026. [link].

[TR2] Lorrie Faith Cranor, Hana Habib, Yaxing Yao, **Yixin Zou**, Alessandro Acquisti, Joel Reidenberg, Norman Sadeh, and Florian Schaub. *CCPA Opt-Out Icon Testing – Phase 2*. Technical Report. Report submitted to the California Office of the Attorney General. 2020. [link].

[TR3] Lorrie Faith Cranor, Hana Habib, **Yixin Zou**, Alessandro Acquisti, Joel Reidenberg, Norman Sadeh, and Florian Schaub. *Design and Evaluation of a Usable Icon and Tagline to Signal an Opt-Out of the Sale of Personal Information as Required by CCPA*. Technical Report. Report submitted to the California Office of the Attorney General. 2020. [link].

[TR4] Lorrie Faith Cranor, Hana Habib, **Yixin Zou**, Alessandro Acquisti, Joel Reidenberg, Norman Sadeh, and Florian Schaub. *User Testing of the Proposed CCPA Do-Not-Sell Icon*. Technical Report. Report submitted to the California Office of the Attorney General. 2020. [link].

Dissertations

[D1] **Yixin Zou**. "Understanding and Improving Consumers' Adoption of Online Privacy-Protective Behaviors". PhD dissertation. University of Michigan. 2022. [link].
ACM SIGCHI Outstanding Dissertation Award.

Grants and Competitive Gifts

2025 DAAD Germany/Hong Kong Joint Research Scheme: *Are We Ready to Tackle Online Misinformation at Scale? A Comprehensive Benchmark and Evaluation of LLM-based Fact-checking Paradigms on Social Media*
€12,870 at MPI-SP | 01.01.26-31.12.27 | DAAD PI; with RGC PI Yupeng Li

2024 Google Academic Research Award: *Safeguarding Emerging Adults from Scams on Short-Form Video Platforms*
$100,000 (€56,894 at MPI-SP) | 01.07.25-30.06.26 | PI; with co-PI Mainack Mondal

2024 NSF-DFG: SaTC: CORE: Small: *Requirements, Metrics, and Tools for Effective and Interpretable Content Moderation Transparency*
€688,690 at MPI-SP | 01.10.25-30.09.28 | DFG PI; with NSF PIs Damon McCoy, Tobias Lauinger, and Elissa Redmiles

2024 CASA Excellence Cluster Fundamental Research Project: *Improving IT Security and Privacy for Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing People*
€253,000 at MPI-SP | 01.09.24-31.08.27 | PI; with co-PI Veelasha Moonsamy

2024 Stanford Internet Observatory Gift: *A Cross-Country Exploration of Security and Privacy Advice*
$15,000 | 01.05.24-30.04.25 | proposal submitted with Collins Munyendo (lead), Veronica Rivera, Jackie Hu, and Elissa Redmiles

2023 CASA Excellence Cluster Fundamental Research Project: *The Whole is Greater than the Sum of Its Parts: Understanding and Improving a Population's Security and Privacy*
€253,000 at MPI-SP | 01.03.23-15.08.26 | co-PI; with PI Angela Sasse

2023 Meta Research Award: *Predictors of Privacy Preferences in Social Virtual Reality*
$100,000 (€16,352 at MPI-SP) | 01.01.23-31.12.23 | co-PI; with PI Anupam Das and co-PI Yaxing Yao

Presentations

Invited Talks and Guest Lectures

2026 INGENIO, joint research center between the Spanish National Research Council (CSIC) and the Polytechnic University of Valencia (UPV) *(Upcoming)*
Hong Kong Baptist University, Department of Interactive Media *(Upcoming)*
University of Bern, Institute of Psychology Colloquium *(Upcoming)*
IFIP Summer School on Privacy and Identity Management *(Keynote)*
CNIL Privacy Research Day
Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security and Law *(Guest Lecture)*
University of Bonn, Dept. for Security and Networked Systems Research Seminar *(Guest Lecture)*
SPRINT Workshop on AI Security and Privacy

2025 Google, Privacy Sandbox Team
Sabanci University, Faculty of Engineering and Natural Sciences *(Guest Lecture)*
University of Luxembourg, MSc. Cybersecurity Lecture Series *(Guest Lecture)*

2024 CNIL Privacy Research Day
ACM SIGCHI Outstanding Dissertation Awardee Invited Talk
Paderborn University, MSc. Privacy and Technology *(Guest Lecture)*

2023 Women in Security and Cryptography (WISC) Workshop
Security and Human Behavior (SHB) Workshop
Cornell, Maryland, Max Planck Pre-doctoral Research School *(Guest Lecture)*
Carnegie Mellon University, Current Topics in Privacy Seminar *(Guest Lecture)*
University of Denver, Human-Centered Data Security and Privacy *(Guest Lecture)*

2022 MPI-SP Symposium on Human and Societal Aspects in Computing
Northeastern University, Khoury College of Computer Sciences
North Carolina State University, Department of Computer Science

Virginia Tech, Department of Computer Science
New York University Shanghai, Department of Computer Science
Arizona State University, School of Computing and Augmented Intelligence
Pennsylvania State University, College of Information Sciences and Technology
Georgia Institute of Technology, School of Interactive Computing
CISPA – the Helmholtz Center for Information Security
University of Tennessee, School of Information
Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy
University College London, Department of Computer Science
Drexel University, College of Computing & Informatics
University of Texas at Austin, School of Information
Duke University, Department of Computer Science
National University of Singapore, Department of Information Systems

2021 Capital-Area Colloquium on Trustworthy & Usable Security/Privacy
The US Federal Trade Commission, Internal Seminar
Karlsruhe Institute of Technology, SECUSO Group
University of Michigan, Identity Theft Causes & Countermeasures *(Guest Lecture)*
University of Michigan, Sexual Assault Prevention and Awareness Center

2020 The US Federal Trade Commission, PrivacyCon

2019 The US Federal Trade Commission, PrivacyCon
University of Michigan, Introduction to Information *(Guest Lecture)*

2018 Mozilla, Firefox Monitor Team

Invited Panel Participation

2025 MPI-SP Symposium on Challenges in a Digitalized Society
2025 Google, Workshop on "Post(card)s from Tokyo: A Safer Digital Future"
2023 SecHuman Workshop on Trust and Resilience in Digital Societies

Media Apperances

(Inter)national and Local Media

2026 Interviewed and quoted by *Proton*: "Nearly half of Germans think end-to-end encryption is very important, but they're still using services that don't offer it." [link]

2022 Research featured by *TechXplore*: "Considering trauma in tech design could benefit all users." [link]

2021 Research featured by *Metaverse Law*: "Opt-Out Icons and Apple Privacy Labels: The Visual Privacy Policy." [link]
Interviewed by *WXYZ-TV* Detroit Channel 7: "Data Breach Dangers." [video]

2020 Interviewed and quoted by *CIO Dive*: "The Remote Playbook: Employees are an attacker's dream." [link]
Research featured by *Mozilla Blog*: "Designing a Content-First Experience on Firefox Monitor." [link]

Research featured by *Chicago Policy Review*: "Data Breach Notifications Are Too Complex." [link]

2018 Research featured by *The New York Times*: "Freezing Credit Will Now Be Free. Here's Why You Should Go for It." [link]
Interviewed and quoted by *Detroit Free Press*: "Credit freeze: A misunderstood freebie." [link]

University Media

2025 *RUB News*: "How People Worldwide Understand Digital Security." [link]

2024 *Podcast Nachgehackt*: "On the Way to More Digital Security and Privacy for All." [video] [audio]
CASA Stories: "Yixin Zou on Working within Bochum Cybersecurity Research." [video]
CASA News: "One Year at CASA: Yixin Zou's Research Experience." [link]

2021 *Michigan News*: "Data breaches: Most victims unaware when shown evidence of multiple compromised accounts." [link]

Op-ed

2021 Co-authored "An open letter to the U-M community" on *Michigan Daily* about anti-Asian racism in the United States and in academia. [link]

Teaching

As Primary or Co-Instructor

212044 AI Ethics and Society
Ruhr University Bochum | course co-taught with Gabriel Lima | Offered in WS 25/26, WS 26/27

212037 Privacy Engineering, Usability, and Data Governance
Ruhr University Bochum | course co-taught with Veelasha Moonsamy and Asia Biega | Offered in WS 23/24, WS 24/25, WS 25/26

As Teaching Assistant

SI 501 Contextual Inquiry
University of Michigan | Instructor: Kentaro Toyama | Fall 2019

SI 110 Introduction to Information
University of Michigan | Instructor: Chris Teplovs | Fall 2018

Community Outreach

2022 Phone Classes with Older Adults
Collaborated with Clear Computing LLC to deliver classes about smartphone use at the Glacier Hills Senior Living Community.

2021 Online Self-Defense Workshops with Older Adults

Led a three-week workshop series in partnership with Ann Arbor Senior Center, Chelsea Senior Center, and Saline Senior Center to teach older adults about risks and protective measures in technology use.

Academic Advising

Current Advisees

2026–	Tarini Saka	Postdoc
2026–	Lawrence Piao	Research Intern
2025–	Kentrell Owens	Postdoc
2025–	Xiaowei Chen	Postdoc (co-advised with Thorsten Holz)
2025–	Guanming Shi	Ph.D. student
2025–	Yasamin Golzar	Ph.D. student (co-advised with Marcel Böhme)
2024–	Priyasha Chatterjee	Ph.D. student
2024–	Mindy Tran	Ph.D. student
2023–	Gabriel Lima	Ph.D. student

Past Advisees

2025–26	Veronica Rivera	Postdoc –> Assistant Professor, Georgia Tech
2025	Yue Deng	Visiting Ph.D. student, HKUST –> Postdoc, MPI-SP
2025	Ankolika De	Visiting Ph.D. student, Penn State –> Postdoc, Vanderbilt University
2025	Marcos Silva	Research intern –> Senior Intelligence Analyst, Wabtec
2025	Xiaowei Chen	Visiting Ph.D. student, University of Luxembourg –> Postdoc, MPI-SP
2024–25	Emmanuel Tweneboah	Research intern –> Master's student, Ruhr University Bochum
2024	Kyle Beadle	Visiting Ph.D. student, UCL –> Postdoc, Inria
2023–24	Collins Munyendo	Visiting Ph.D. student, the George Washington University –> Postdoc, UC Berkeley
2023–24	Smirity Kaushik	Visiting Ph.D. student, UIUC –> Postdoc, the George Washington University
2023–24	Mindy Tran	Research intern –> Ph.D. student, MPI-SP
2023	Johanna Gunawan	Visiting Ph.D. student, Northeastern –> Assistant Professor, Maastricht University
2023	Jackie Hu	Research intern –> Ph.D. student, University of Michigan
2023	Princessa Cintaqia	Research intern –> Ph.D. student, Boston University
2023	Xinru Tang	Research intern –> Ph.D. student, UC Irvine

Ph.D. Dissertation Advisory Committee Member

Being on the advisory committee means I regularly meet with the student (sometimes also their primary advisor) to discuss progress.

2026	Franziska Herbert	Ruhr University Bochum, Ph.D. in Computer Science
2025	Smirity Kaushik	UIUC, Ph.D. in Information Sciences
2025	Collins Munyendo	George Washington University, Ph.D. in Computer Science

Ph.D. Dissertation Defense Committee Member

Being on the dissertation defense committee means I read and grade the student's dissertation, but I am less involved in the day-to-day advising.

2026	Sangavi Shanthakumar	Ruhr University Bochum, Ph.D. in Computer Science
2026	Asli Yardim	Ruhr University Bochum, Ph.D. in Computer Science
2025	Nele Borgert	Ruhr University Bochum, Ph.D. in Psychology
2025	Xiaowei Chen	University of Luxembourg, Ph.D. in Psychology
2024	Jonas Hielscher	Ruhr University Bochum, Ph.D. in Computer Science

Supervision of Bachelor's and Master's Theses

2026	Batoul Abi Zaid	Ruhr University Bochum, Master's thesis
2026	Sebastian Kirchheiner	Ruhr University Bochum, Master's thesis
2025	Sophie-Charlotte Sommer	Ruhr University Bochum, Bachelor's thesis
2024	Agata Stanczyk	Ruhr University Bochum, Master's thesis

Pair Mentoring in Diversity-Related Mentoring Program

2024–25	Hannah Greß	University of Bonn
2023–24	Emily Courtney	University of Passau

As a Ph.D. Student at the University of Michigan

2022	Annie Chen	University of Michigan, BSc. in Computer Science
2022	J.R. Robert Real	University of Michigan, MSc. in Information and LL.M.
2022	Sean Scarnecchia	University of Michigan, BSc. in Computer Science
2021–22	Tanisha Afnan	University of Michigan, Ph.D. in Information
2021–22	Janet X Chen	Cornell Tech, Ph.D. in Information Sciences
2021–22	Khue Le	University of Michigan, BSc. in Computer Science
2021–22	Kaiwen Sun	University of Michigan, Ph.D. in Information
2021	Julia Narakornpichit	Cornell Tech, MSc. in Connective Media
2021	Carlo Sugatan	University of Michigan, MSc. in Information
2019–20	Michael Ni	University of Michigan, BSc. in Computer Science
2019–20	Jamie Lai	University of Michigan, BSc. in Information
2018	Aditi Jannu	Carnegie Mellon University, MSc. in Information Technology
2018	Chelse Swoopes	Carnegie Mellon University, MSc. in ECE
2018	Shawn Danino	University of Michigan, MSc. in Information
2018	Austin McCall	University of Michigan, BSc. in Information

Service

Academic Community Service

Senior Reviewing and Organizing Roles

General Co-Chair, SCP: Conference on Sociotechnical Cybersecurity and Privacy (2027)
Panel Co-Chair, CHI: ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2027)
Vice Program Chair, PETS: Privacy Enhancing Technologies Symposium (2026, 2027)

Track Co-Chair, ACM CCS Usability & Measurement Track (2025)
PC Co-Chair, USEC: Symposium on Usable Security and Privacy (2023)

Program Committee Member / Area Chair / Associate Chair / Editorial Board Member
CHI: ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2024, 2025, 2026, 2027)
CSCW: Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction – Computer-Supported Cooperative Work (2023, 2026–)
FAccT: ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (2026)
ASSETS: ACM Conference on Computers and Accessibility (2026)
Euro S&P: IEEE European Symposium on Security and Privacy (2026)
SOUPS: Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (2024, 2025, 2026)
CCS: ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (2023, 2024)
PETS: Privacy Enhancing Technologies Symposium (2023, 2025)
USENIX Security Symposium (2023)
RAID: International Symposium on Research in Attacks, Intrusions and Defenses (2022)

Workshop Organizing
2026, SOUPS. *Workshop on Societal Impact for Usable Privacy and Security Research (Impact@SOUPS)*. Co-lead Organizer. [website]
2026, SOUPS. *Workshop on Surveillance and Usable Privacy (SUP)*. Co-Organizer. [website]
2026, Mensch und Computer (MuC) Conference. *Human-Centered Moderation: Expertise, Context, and Evaluation*. Co-Organizer. [website]
2023, ACM ASSETS. *Bridging the Gap: Towards Advancing Privacy and Accessibility*. Co-Organizer. [proposal][website]

Workshop Program Committee Member
AsiaCCS Workshop on Security and Privacy for Asian Internet Communities (2026)
PrivaCI Symposium (2025)
CSAW Applied Research Competition (2024)
EuroUSEC: European Symposium on Usable Security (2021)
ACM CHI Late-Breaking Work (2020, 2021)

Award Selection Committee Member
CNIL-Inria Privacy Award (2026)
USEC Test-of-Time Award (2025)
SOUPS Best Paper Award (2025)
SOUPS Karat Award (2024)
SOUPS Impact Award (2024)

Other Conference Service
Stipend Committee Member, PETS (2024)
Birds-of-a-Feather Session Co-Chair, PETS (2023)
Publicity Co-Chair, SOUPS (2022, 2023, 2024)
Posters Junior Co-Chair, SOUPS (2021)

External Reviewing
I have served as an external reviewer at least once for the following venues.

Journals
ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction (TOCHI)
ACM Transactions on Privacy and Security (TOPS)
Behaviour & Information Technology
IEEE Transactions on Dependable and Secure Computing
IEEE Security and Privacy Magazine
International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction (IJHCI)
International Journal of Human-Computer Studies (IJHCS)
Journal of Cybersecurity
Journal of the Association for Information Science and Technology (JASIST)
Conferences
ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS)
ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT)
Grant reviewing panels
U.S. National Science Foundation, Security, Privacy, and Trust in Cyberspace (SaTC)
Israel Science Foundation (ISF)

Review Awards and Recognitions

Outstanding Reviewer, PETS (2023)
Noteworthy Reviewer, USENIX Security (2023)

My reviews have also received "special recognition for outstanding reviews" or the "good review" flags at CCS (2023, 2024), CHI (2024, 2025, 2026), CSCW (2020, 2024), PoPETs (2025), Euro S&P (2026), and SOUPS (2024, 2025, 2026).

Institutional Service

2025–28	Scientific Staff Representative, MPG Chemistry, Physics and Technology Section
2025–	Member, MPI-SP Ethics Review Board
2025	Co-Organizer, MPI-SP Symposium on Challenges in a Digitalized Society
2024	Co-Founder, MPI-SP Buddy Program
2023–24	Co-Chair, CS@Max Planck Internship Program
2023	Admission Committee Member, CS@Max Planck Doctoral Program
2023	Admission Committee Member, Maryland Max Planck PhD Program
2023	Admission Committee Member, CS@Max Planck Internship Program